

Who was the very first photographer ?

Some contenders

1802

Humphry Davy: silver nitrate on glass and paper
(Not permanent)

1826

Joseph Niépce: Heliography (tar on pewter plate)
(VERY long exposure times)

1839

Louis Daguerre: Daguerreotype (silver on copper)
(First commercially viable process)

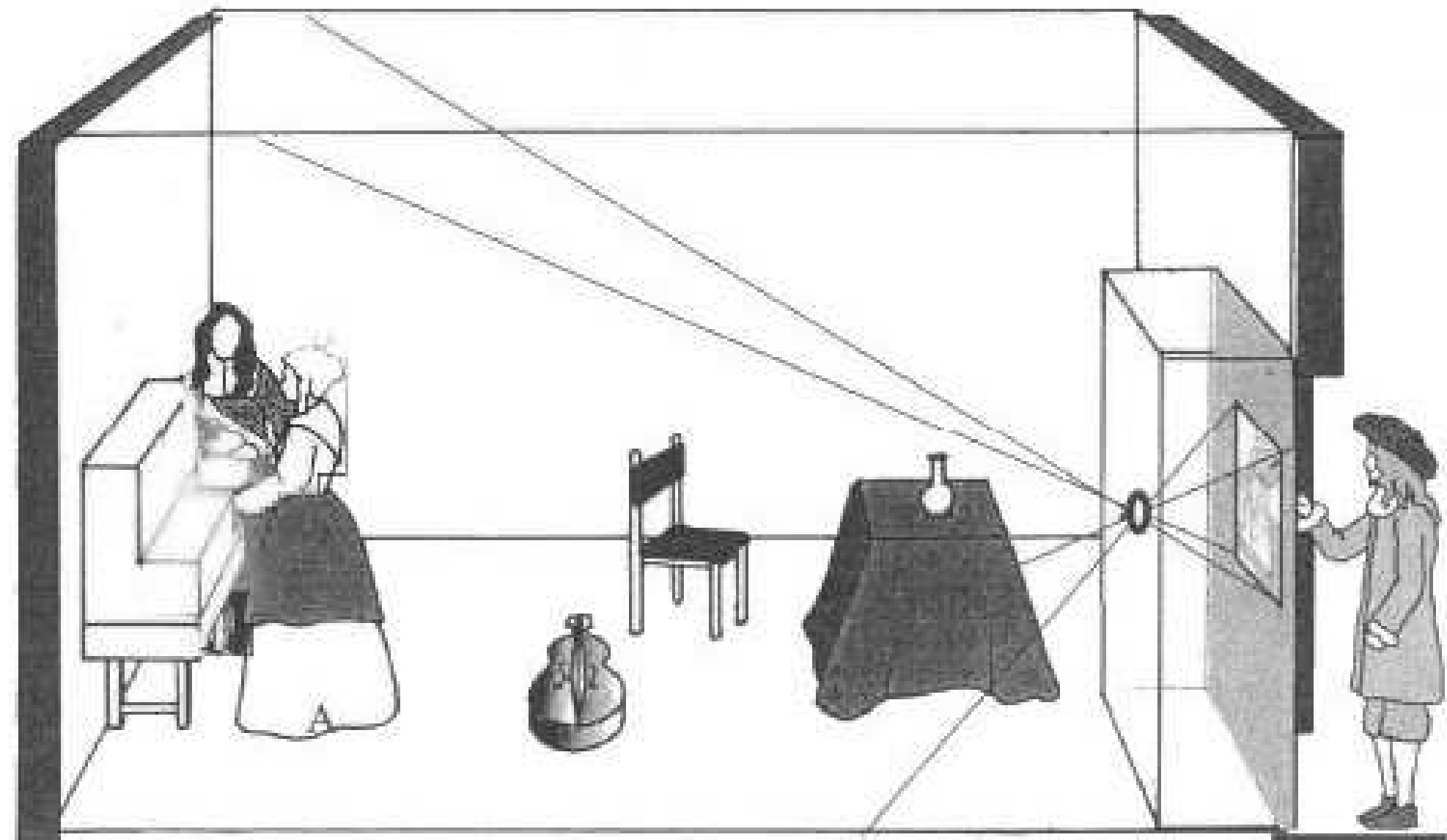
1665: Johannes Vermeer

Dutch painter: Born in 1632, died in 1675
Famous for domestic scenes of the middle-classes
Specialised in "Photorealistic" paintings
With special attention to perspective
Much speculation as to his process

He is perhaps most famous for
The Music Lesson (1665)...



He was a painter, why talk about him now ?



Was he a photographer ?

Well, he did use a camera (obscura)
There was a lens (or at least a pin-hole)
The image was projected onto a plate
He had to consider composition, angle, framing etc.

Sure, he had to manually capture the image
(using dabs of mixed-colour paint)
But then, all early photographic processes...
Involved some kind of manual chemical activity

How is this relevant ?

This is what YOU will be doing next week !
(or at least your CODE will be doing)

You will be using a (conceptual) camera
You will be composing an image using "dabs" of colour
You will need to think about distances and angles

"Music Lesson" is a great render test image !

- Perspective-corrected textures (checkerboard)
- Glass (with imperfect diffused refraction)
- Shadows (with multiple light sources)
- Spheres (with specular highlights)
- Mirrors (with reflected scene elements)

